
MOVEMENTAL · ONBOARDED LEADER RESEARCH

Summary

Movement leader research dossier — profile, content catalog, digital presence, fragmentation story, and onboarding materials.

Generated June 09, 2026 · 30 sections · Slug: liz-rios

Contents

1. 1. Research Index
2. 2. At a Glance — Summary
3. 3. Author Profile — Identity
4. 4. Biography
5. 5. Theological Profile
6. 6. Vocational Profile
7. 7. Voice & Editorial Identity
8. 8. Bibliography
9. 9. Frameworks
10. 10. Articles & Blog Posts
11. 11. Audio & Podcast
12. 12. Video Content
13. 13. Content Audit
14. 14. Academic Work
15. 15. Courses & Training
16. 16. Organizations & Affiliations
17. 17. Audience & Reach
18. 18. Websites
19. 19. Publishing Platforms
20. 20. Newsletters
21. 21. Social Media
22. 22. The Fragmentation Story
23. 23. A Letter — Reflected Understanding
24. 24. Welcome Letter
25. 25. Committed Voice
26. 26. Sources
27. 27. Misc · Digital-Presence-Source
28. 28. Misc · Network · Affiliations
29. 29. Misc · Network · Endorsers
30. 30. Misc · Network · Movemental-Overlap

Research Index

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/README.md

Liz Rios — research sidebar manifest

Canonical paths aligned with Author Profile `/profile` navigation.

Sidebar slug	File	Status
author-profile	profile/identity.md	populated
author-profile	network/organizations.md	populated
biography	profile/biography.md	populated
theological-profile	profile/theology.md	empty
vocational-profile	summary.md	populated
vocational-profile	profile/calling-profile.md	empty
voice-editorial-identity	profile/voice-analysis.md	populated
bibliography	content/books.md	empty
frameworks	content/frameworks.md	populated
articles-blog-posts	content/articles.md	empty
audio-podcast	content/audio.md	empty
video-content	content/videos.md	empty
content-audit	content/content-audit.md	populated
academic-work	content/academic.md	empty
courses-training	content/courses.md	empty
audience-profile	analysis/audience-analysis.md	empty
where-you-publish	digital-presence/websites.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/platforms.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/newsletters.md	populated
social-media	digital-presence/social-media.md	populated
the-fragmentation-story	fragmentation-story.md	populated
a-letter	reflected-understanding/liz-rios.md	populated
(onboarding)	welcome-letter.md	populated

Staff-only research lives in `_staff/`; collateral in `_misc/`.

At a Glance — Summary

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/summary.md

Summary — Rev. Dr. Liz Rios

One-page executive synthesis. Last updated 2026-04-20.

Who

Rev. Dr. Elizabeth "Liz" D. Rios. Afro-Boricua theologian, ordained Disciples of Christ (prior AG). 35+ years in ministry. BA, MA, EdD (Nova Southeastern), DMin (Southeastern), MA Social Justice (Union, 2025). Based Central Florida + Puerto Rico.

What she runs

- **Passion2Plant** (founded 2020) — only national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network in the U.S.
- **The Passion Center** — her missional online faith community and training platform.
- **Púlpito Fellows** — 3-year preaching fellowship, Lilly Endowment funded, bilingual 10-week cohorts. Director.
- **Latinas of Legacy, Cafecito Conversations** — her own video series.

Current affiliations

Board, Sojourners · Executive Team, Latino Leadership Circle · Adjunct, Fuller Seminary · Senior Consultant, Freedom Road (Lisa Sharon Harper) · Consulting Editor, Outreach Magazine · Commission on Ministry, Disciples of Christ · Senior Mentor, R.E.A.L. THRIVE · Co-vocational, Urban Strategies.

Published

- Don't Buy The Lie (sole author, 2012).
- Contributor to **100 Movements Publishing's** Need to Know (with Alan Hirsch, Danielle Strickland, Jo Saxton, Scot McKnight, Lisa Rodriguez-Watson, Beth Allison Barr, Mandy Smith, Lori Anne Thompson, Bob Ekblad).
- Co-curator/contributor Rhythms of Rest (Our Daily Bread).
- "The Women are Warriors" — Oxford University Press chapter (reprinted in Azusa Street centennial volume).
- Columns in Sojourners, Christianity Today, Influence, Called, PCPJ, Red Letter Christians, Latin Business Today, The Atlantic, Washington Post, RNS.
- Substack Mujerista in Motion + Medium [drlizrios](#).

Recognitions

Outreach Magazine cover (2007) · Hispanic Women of Distinction (2014) · MLK Jr. College Board of Preachers (2023) · Trailblazer (2023) · Unsung Sheroe (2023) · Latina in Ministry (2024) · **Only woman inducted, Palm Beach Atlantic's inaugural Florida College of Preachers (Oct 2025).**

Why she matters to Movemental

1. **Already in the 100 Movements publishing universe** — shortest warm-intro path via Alan, Danielle, or Lisa RW.
2. **Live cohort operator with real digital deliverables** — Pulpito Fellows is a customer-zero-grade use case for the Content System Build.
3. **Diversifies the platform's theological and demographic surface area** in a way no current leader does — Afro-Boricua, mujerista, bilingual, BIPOC-woman church planter.
4. **Her own digital infrastructure is fragmented** (three domains, two newsletters, two YouTube channels, one podcast) — classic case for platform consolidation.

Demo priority: secondary

Bridge narrative, distinct audience, strong existing credibility — but she already has her own brand and would be a co-marketing partner, not a greenfield tenant. POC should be framed as augmentation of Passion2Plant / Pulpito Fellows, not replacement.

Immediate next actions

1. Warm intro via Danielle Strickland or Lisa Rodriguez-Watson.
2. 30-45 min primary interview (platform, content, bilingual strategy).
3. Technical audit of her three public domains.
4. Draft 2-page "Pulpito Fellows on Movemental" POC.

Top open questions

- Direct relationship with Alan?
- Funder mix beyond Lilly?
- Willingness to engage AI voice-agent tooling given mujerista authenticity commitments?
- Is she shopping for a platform or settled on existing stack?

Author Profile — Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/profile/identity.md

Identity — Rev. Dr. Liz Rios

How she describes herself

- "Afro-Boricua theologian, educator, and activist"
- "Nuyorican Afro-Latina writer/activist"
- "Multi-hyphenate creative"
- "Mujerista in motion" (Substack handle / self-naming)

Theological coordinates

- **Mujerista theology** (Ada María Isasi-Díaz lineage) — theology from the lived experience of Latinas
- **Barrio theology** — contextual theology rooted in urban Latinx neighborhoods
- **Pentecostal / Charismatic** formation (AG roots) integrated with Disciples of Christ ecclesiology
- **Justice-oriented ecclesiology** — her DMin thesis and public teaching argue civic engagement and justice are constitutive of church planting, not add-ons
- **Egalitarian / women-in-leadership** — core conviction; anchored the Center for Emerging Female Leadership (1996–2001) and still the drumbeat of Passion2Plant and Need to Know

Signature framings she returns to

- **"Global majority" planters** — preferred term over "minority" or "ethnic"
- **"Holistic, justice-focused churches"** — contra the church-growth / attractional model she was trained in
- **"The digital pulpit"** — Pulpito Fellows thesis: social media and streaming are not adjuncts to ministry, they are ministry surface area for this generation of Latina/o leaders
- **"Prophetic legacy"** — her Mama Leo Lecture keynote title at Union (2024); Leoncia Rosado Rousseau (NYC's first Latina pastor) as formational figure
- **"Women are warriors"** — chapter title in Latino Religions and Civic Activism (Oxford UP); recurring motif

Rhetorical posture

- **Autobiographical-theological** — routinely grounds argument in her own lived experience (Lower East Side, Afro-Boricua, mother of a child with special needs, widowed-in-grief narrative arc around Daniel)
- **Naming exclusions explicitly** — her own founding of Passion2Plant is narrated as a response to church planting networks that "did not prepare me for the real challenges I faced as a BIPOC woman planting a church in a community marked by poverty, systemic neglect, and food insecurity"
- **Disrupt/cultivate binary** — Passion2Plant mission: "disrupt oppressive systems and cultivate faith spaces of transformation"
- **Bilingual register** — Spanish-English code-switching is a consistent content signal (Púlpito, Cafecito Conversations, Mujerista, Latinas of Legacy)

Core convictions (inferable from corpus)

1. The future of U.S. Christianity runs through Latina/o, Black, and bivocational BIPOC women.
2. Church planting training as currently designed centers white, male, attractional assumptions; retraining the field requires new curricula authored from the margins.
3. Justice praxis (civic engagement, anti-Christian-Nationalism, anti-death-penalty, pro-immigrant) is theologically non-negotiable.
4. Spiritual formation and trauma-informed pastoral care are inseparable from church planting health.
5. Digital tools are liberation tools when stewarded by those previously excluded from the pulpit.
6. Women's leadership is not an HR question; it is an ecclesiological and eschatological one.

Biography

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Biography — Rev. Dr. Elizabeth "Liz" D. Rios

Identity

- **Full name:** Elizabeth D. Rios
- **Preferred:** Liz Rios / Dr. Liz
- **Self-identifiers:** Afro-Boricua, Nuyorican Afro-Latina, mujerista theologian, "multi-hyphenate creative"
- **Birthplace:** Brooklyn, NY
- **Raised:** Lower East Side, Manhattan
- **Current base:** Central Florida + Puerto Rico (formerly Miramar / South Florida for 20 years)
- **Family:** Married to Rev. Hiram Rios (35+ years); sons Samuel and Daniel (who had special needs, transitioned 9/22/2022 at age 23)
- **Sorority:** Delta Sigma Theta, Inc. (39-year member; charter member, South Broward Alumnae Chapter)

Call to ministry

At age 11 she discerned a call to leadership. Formation was shaped by Latino Pentecostal (Assemblies of God) roots in NYC, initially under Bishop Raymond Rivera / Latino Pastoral Action Center (LPAC), with early credentials through Primitive Christian Church (PCC), NYC.

Education

Degree	Institution	Notes
BA	—	Liberal Arts
MA	—	Management
EdD	Nova Southeastern University	Organizational Leadership. Dissertation: Evaluating Transformative Spirituality in an Organizational Leadership Program at a Christian University
DMin	Southeastern University	Dissertation: Developing Civically Engaged, Justice Oriented Churches Right From the Start
MA	Union Theological Seminary	Social Justice; graduated May 2025

Ordination and credentials

- **Christian Church (Disciples of Christ)** — current ordination. Also serves on its Commission on Ministry.
- Prior credentials through **Assemblies of God** via Primitive Christian Church (PCC), NYC.

Career arc (partial timeline)

Years	Role / Org
1996–2001	Founder, Center for Emerging Female Leadership , NYC — mentored emerging women leaders (earliest flagship initiative)
1996–present	Consultant to schools, faith orgs, small businesses, nonprofits
~mid-2000s	Assistant Professor of Christian Education & Executive Director of Advancement , Nyack College. Launched Urban Ministry Conferences (NYC), drawing hundreds of urban missiologists and practitioners
2008–present	Consulting Editor , Outreach Magazine
2020	Founded Passion2Plant — national BIPOC-woman-led church planting and leadership development network
~2020–present	Founder / Community Curator, The Passion Center — missional online faith community and training center
~2020+	Co-vocational leader, Urban Strategies (20+ years connection)
2024	Launched Púlpito Fellows (Lilly Endowment funded, partnership with Urban Strategies + Passion2Plant). Cohort 1 Spring 2024, Cohort 2 Fall 2024, Cohort 3 2025
2024+	Adjunct Faculty, Fuller Theological Seminary (Church Planting Initiative orbit)
2024+	Board Member, Sojourners
ongoing	Executive Team, Latino Leadership Circle (alongside Rev. David Ramos, Rev. Dr. Orlando Crespo, Rev. Dr. Luis Alvarez, Elder Belinda Passafaro)
4+ yrs	Senior Mentor , R.E.A.L. Black Women in Ministry THRIVE initiative
2008+	Senior Consultant & Special Projects , Freedom Road (Lisa Sharon Harper)
prior	Advisory board, Evangelicals for Social Action
prior	Board member, National Latino Evangelical Coalition (NaLEC)

Recognition (selected)

- Outreach Magazine cover, Nov/Dec 2007 — leading Hispanic faith-based work
- Hispanic Women of Distinction, 2014 — Latina Style / Bank of America
- Multi-cultural Excellence Award, 2022 — City to City Miami
- MLK Jr. College of Ministers and Laity, Board of Preachers — inducted 2023

- Trailblazer Award, 2023 — Influential Global Ministries / Sacramento Midtown Church
- Unsung Sherone Award, 2023 — presented by Amb. Suzan Johnson Cook
- Latina in Ministry Award, 2024 — Latino Pastoral Action Center
- **Only woman inducted**, Florida College of Preachers inaugural class, Oct 2025 — Palm Beach Atlantic University

Encyclopedic presence

- Encyclopedia of Women and Religion in North America, Vol. 1 (2006)
- Latinas in the United States: A Historical Encyclopedia (2006)

Theological Profile

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Vocational Profile

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Voice & Editorial Identity

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Voice analysis — Rev. Dr. Liz Rios

Preliminary voice markers extracted from corpus surface (essays, interviews, keynote titles).
Confirm with primary-source sampling before using for any AI voice-fidelity work.

Register

- **Personal + pastoral + prophetic** — she slides between first-person memoir, pastoral care-language, and prophetic rebuke in a single piece.
- **Bilingual / code-switching** as identity performance, not ornamentation. Spanish titles (Púlpito, Cafecito, Madrinan, Latinas of Legacy) frame English content.
- **Named accountability** — she names people and institutions (both as honor and as critique): Samuel Rodriguez, Christian Nationalism, specific networks that failed her, specific mentors (Mama Leo, Bishop Rivera, Suzan Johnson Cook).

Recurring vocabulary

global majority · BIPOC · mujerista · barrio · justice-oriented · holistic · prophetic ·
emerging (female) leaders · digital pulpit · oppressive systems · cultivate · disrupt · legacy ·
madrinas · cafecito · warriors

Argument patterns

1. **"I was trained in X, and X failed me. Here is what is needed instead."** — origin story of Passion2Plant.
2. **"Before me, there was her."** — positions herself in continuity with unnamed / under-named Latina foremothers (Mama Leo, Ada María Isasi-Díaz).
3. **"Latina/o Christians are X% of the church — ignoring them is ecclesial malpractice."** — demographic framing (Atlantic 2021, Axios 2024).
4. **Justice as formation** — refuses the separation between "spiritual formation" and "civic praxis."
5. **Naming the cost** — explicit about what it has cost her personally (losing a child, being the only woman in rooms, credentialing as double/triple-doctored woman of color to be heard).

What a voice-fidelity agent would need

- A corpus pull from: Substack (Mujerista in Motion), Medium (drlizrios), Sojourners archives, PCPJ archives, Influence magazine archive, Called magazine, Christianity Today contributions, Latin Business Today, DMin dissertation.
- Ideally: 3-5 hours of unedited audio from her keynotes (Mama Leo Lecture 2024, HESD Austin Theological, Fuller CPI response to Len Tang) for cadence and bilingual register.
- Explicit guardrails on:
- Never speak in her voice about Daniel (her son) without her direct approval.
- Never ventriloquize mujerista or Latina-experience first-person claims unless sourced verbatim.
- Maintain Spanish terms untranslated where she leaves them untranslated.

Compare / contrast vs. existing movemental leaders

Dimension	Hirsch	Strickland	Rios
Origin register	Australian Reformed-Pentecostal, systems	Salvation Army global, justice	NYC Latina Pentecostal, mujerista
Primary audience	Global Forge / APEST readers	Women in Western evangelical leadership	BIPOC women planters, Latinx Protestants
Rhetorical mode	Typological + metaphorical	Narrative-activist	Autobiographical-theological + prophetic
Language	English, dense with neologism	English, hortatory	Bilingual, named

She does **not** overlap with Hirsch's voice — she complements it. That is the point.

Representative quotes

"Afro-Boricua theologian, educator, and activist" — self-description (profile/identity.md)

Passion2Plant exists to "disrupt oppressive systems and cultivate faith spaces of transformation." — Passion2Plant mission (profile/identity.md)

She founded Passion2Plant in response to church planting networks that "did not prepare me for the real challenges I faced as a BIPOC woman planting a church in a community marked by poverty, systemic neglect, and food insecurity." — narrated founding account (profile/identity.md)

"Prophetic Legacy: Latina Voices Shaping Church and Society" — Mama Leo Lecture keynote title, Union Theological Seminary, 2024

"The Women are Warriors" — chapter title, *Latino Religions and Civic Activism in the United States* (Oxford UP)

Bibliography

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sidebar: bibliography

Frameworks

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Frameworks: Liz Rios

Exported from movement_leader_corpus_data.frameworks[] — on-disk SSOT for Author Profile.

Mujerista theology (applied)

Field	Value
Introduced	Adopted from the Ada María Isasi-Díaz lineage (not coined by Rios)
Components	Theology from the lived experience of Latinas, grounded in Afro-Boricua, bilingual, and barrio realities
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Substack Mujerista in Motion; Medium essay "The Intersection of Womanist and Mujerista Theology in Embracing Diasporic Afro-Latina Women"; self-identifier "mujerista in motion"
Source	profile/identity.md, committed-voice.md, content/content-audit.md

A contextual theology that grounds church practice in the lived experience of Latinas, in continuity with Ada María Isasi-Díaz.

The digital pulpit

Field	Value
Introduced	Articulated as the Pulpito Fellows thesis (2024)
Components	Social media and streaming are not adjuncts to ministry but the primary surface area / "pulpit" for this generation of Latina/o leaders
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Pulpito Fellows fellowship deliverable: each fellow creates three digital products; Pulpito Voices YouTube channel
Source	profile/identity.md, committed-voice.md, network/affiliations.md

Reframes digital tools as liberation tools and ministry surface area when stewarded by those previously excluded from the pulpit.

Holistic, justice-focused churches

Field	Value
Introduced	DMin thesis Developing Civically Engaged, Justice Oriented Churches Right From the Start
Components	Civic engagement and justice praxis are constitutive of healthy church planting, not optional add-ons; contra the church-growth / attractional model
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	DMin dissertation (Southeastern); Sojourners and PCPJ articles; Passion2Plant "Just Church" cohort track
Source	profile/identity.md, content/content-audit.md, network/affiliations.md

Argues that justice orientation and civic engagement are formative and constitutive of church planting "right from the start."

Global majority planters

Field	Value
Introduced	Recurring signature framing (date not documented)
Components	Preferred frame over "minority" or "ethnic"; names BIPOC planters as the demographic core of the future U.S. church rather than a niche
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Demographic framing in The Atlantic (2021) and Axios (2024) coverage; Passion2Plant network identity
Source	profile/identity.md, profile/voice-analysis.md

Prophetic legacy

Field	Value
Introduced	Mama Leo Lecture keynote title, Union Theological Seminary (2024)
Components	Self-naming in continuity with under-celebrated Latina foremothers (Leoncia "Mama Leo" Rosado Rousseau, Ada María Isasi-Díaz) — claiming ancestry as ecclesial authorization
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	2024 keynote "Prophetic Legacy: Latina Voices Shaping Church and Society"
Source	profile/identity.md, committed-voice.md, content/content-audit.md

Disrupt and cultivate

Field	Value
Introduced	Passion2Plant mission grammar (2020)
Components	Two-beat mission: "disrupt oppressive systems and cultivate faith spaces of transformation," held together as one move
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Passion2Plant mission statement
Source	profile/identity.md, committed-voice.md

Articles & Blog Posts

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sidebar: articles-blog-posts

Audio & Podcast

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sidebar: audio-podcast

Video Content

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status: empty

sidebar: video-content

Content Audit

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Content audit — Rev. Dr. Liz Rios

Books (authored)

#	Title	Publisher	Year	Role
1	Don't Buy The Lie: Eradicating False Belief Systems That Keep You From Your Destiny	Ghetto Rose Publications	2012	Sole author

Books (curated / contributed)

#	Title	Publisher	Year	Role	Notable co-contributors
2	Need to Know: Empowering Female Leadership and Why It's Essential for the Future of the Church	100 Movements Publishing (Alan Hirsch's imprint)	2023	Contributor (21-voice collection curated by Danielle Strickland)	Alan Hirsch , Scot McKnight, Jo Saxton, Lisa Rodriguez-Watson, Beth Allison Barr, Mandy Smith, Bob Ekblad, Lori Anne Thompson
3	Rhythms of Rest: 40 Devotions for Women on the Move	Our Daily Bread Publishing	—	Contributor + book curator (alongside Amb. Suzan Johnson Cook); contributors drawn from Black and multicultural communities	

Scholarly chapters

#	Title	Volume	Publisher
4	"The Women are Warriors"	Latino Religions and Civic Activism in the United States	Oxford University Press
5	"The Women are Warriors" (reprint)	Azusa Street and Beyond: 100 Years of Commentary on the Global/Pentecostal Charismatic Movement	—

Dissertations

- Developing Civically Engaged, Justice Oriented Churches Right From the Start — DMin, Southeastern University (firescholars.seu.edu)
- Evaluating Transformative Spirituality in an Organizational Leadership Program at a Christian University — EdD, Nova Southeastern University (nsuworks.nova.edu)

Columns / regular platforms

- **Substack:** Mujerista in Motion ([drlizrios](#))
- **Medium:** [drlizrios.medium.com](#)
- **Outreach Magazine:** Consulting Editor since 2008
- **The Passion Center:** [thepassioncenter.org](#) (own platform)

Articles (selected — confirm full list via direct archive pull)

Outlet	Title	Date
Sojourners	"The Urgent Need for Justice-Oriented Churches in the U.S."	—
Sojourners	"Latino Evangelicals Say NO to the Death Penalty"	Jul 2015
Send Institute	"COVID-19's Burden on the Black and Brown Church"	2020
Influence Magazine	"Church Dropouts" (series)	—
Christianity Today	"Why Latino Christians Treasure January 6"	—
PCPJ	"Justice as Electoral Praxis: Hope for Florida, Latina Evangelicas and Election 2020"	2020
Red Letter Christians	"Faith Is on the Ballot: A Call for the Latino Vote"	—
Called Magazine	"Are we Called to Confront?"	—
Medium	"The Intersection of Womanist and Mujerista Theology in Embracing Diasporic Afro-Latina Women"	—
Voyage Tampa	"Conversations with Elizabeth Rios"	—
Latin Business Today	Small-business column (multiple)	ongoing

Other listed outlets (confirmed at [elizabethrios.com/media](#)): The Atlantic, The Washington Post, Religion News Service, PRISM, Pentecostals and Charismatics for Peace and Justice.

Podcast appearances (guest)

- Be the Bridge with Latasha Morrison — "Leaders of Color: Latinx with Dr. Elizabeth Rios"
- The Mestizo Podcast with Emanuel Padilla — "Loving DJ"
- The Protagonistas with Kat Armas — "Theology in El Barrio"
- The Black Church Still Speaks — Multiethnic Ministry & Women in Leadership
- Ephesiology Podcast — "Disciples Learn" / "Make Disciples" series

- Right Side Up (Danielle Strickland) — Need To Know Episode 10, with Lisa Rodriguez Watson
- And the Church Said — Passion2Plant with Dr. Liz Rios
- The Church Planting Podcast — with Greg Nettle and Len Tang
- Hispanic Initiatives of the Church of God in Christ — with John Edward Perez, Dr. Eli Valentín
- Two Mothers, One Aché — Grief and Religion

Podcasts (host / moderator)

- **Latino Leadership Circle Podcast** (Apple Podcasts) — moderator

Keynotes / major lectures

- **4th Annual Mama Leo Lecture Series, Union Theological Seminary** — "Prophetic Legacy: Latina Voices Shaping Church and Society" (2024)
- **HESD gathering, Austin Theological Seminary** — "Prophetic Leadership for a Liberated Tomorrow"
- **Fuller Missiology Lectures 2023** — response with Daniel Yang, Len Tang, Dr. Soong-Chan Rah on Church Planting as Evangelism
- **Wheaton College (Billy Graham Center), June 2020** — Holistic & Locally Present Engagement During Pandemic
- **NaLEC Latino Summit**, July 2018 — panelist with Dr. Ed Stetzer
- **CPLF2019 Gathering**, Wheaton College — Hispanic Church Planting Survey panel
- **Latino-American Church Planting Think Tank**, Feb 2020

Video series (own platforms)

- Cafecito Conversations — Madrinas · Sisterhood Alliances · Lessons from our Fathers
- Latinas of Legacy
- Passion2Plant Mentor Moment — "Lessons from 40 Years of Ministry"
- Women in Church Planting: Imposter Syndrome
- Interviews with Daniel Yang, Dr. Susan Maros, Dr. Susan Harris Howell, Sheila Wray Gregoire

Media coverage (selected)

- The Atlantic — "The Fastest-Growing Group of American Evangelicals" (July 2021)
- Religion News Service — "Women Church Planters Hope to Give Christianity a Fresh Start" (Aug 19, 2021)
- Religion News Service — "Black and Latino Startup Churches Work to Stay Afloat During Pandemic" (Mar 27, 2020)

- Religion News Service — "Women ministers resist misogyny..." (Sept 3, 2025; Louisville Study)
- Washington Post — "Latino Faith Leaders to Gather for Summit on Christian Nationalism" (May 17, 2023)
- Axios — "Survey: 55% of Latino Protestants support Christian Nationalism" (Feb 29, 2024)
- AFRO — "Black women in ministry recognized as 'Unsung She-ros'"

Research led / sits on committees for

- LifeWay Research Hispanic Church Planting Report — survey of 218 new church works (committee member)
- Hidden Figures: Celebrating Pentecostal Women
- Women in Ministry Study
- Latinas of Legacy
- Justice Oriented Churches

Volume estimate

- **Books:** 1 sole-authored, 2 curated/contributed, 2 Oxford chapter(s) = ~5 book-level artifacts
- **Articles:** 40+ known; archive-complete figure likely 100+ over a 20-year writing career
- **Podcasts:** 15+ guest appearances + ongoing Latino Leadership Circle moderator role
- **Keynotes:** ongoing speaking practice, multiple per year, national and seminary-based

Academic Work

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Courses & Training

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sidebar: courses-training

Organizations & Affiliations

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Affiliations — Rev. Dr. Liz Rios

Organizations she has **founded, led, taught at, sat on a board of, or consulted for**, with approximate time windows.

Organizations founded

Org	Role	Est.	Still active	Notes
Passion2Plant	Founder	2020	Yes	Only national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network in the U.S. Three cohorts: Just Church, Trauma, Pulpito Fellows.
The Passion Center	Founder & Community Curator	~2020	Yes	Missional online faith community + training center. Umbrella brand for her teaching/media work.
Center for Emerging Female Leadership (NYC)	Founder	1996	Closed 2001	Earliest flagship; mentored emerging women leaders in NYC.
Urban Ministry Conferences (at Nyack College)	Founder / Convener	mid-2000s	Unclear	Drew hundreds of urban missiologists and practitioners.

Programs she currently directs

Program	Parent org	Funder	Start	Structure
Pulpito Fellows	Urban Strategies (in partnership w/ Passion2Plant)	Lilly Endowment	Spring 2024	3-year preaching fellowship, 10-week cohorts, bilingual, 1.5-day in-person launch + 8 Zoom sessions. Each fellow creates 3 digital products. Coordinator: Rev. Aracelis Vasquez Haye.

Current board / leadership roles

Org	Role	Domain
Sojourners	Board Member	Ecumenical Christian media & justice advocacy
Latino Leadership Circle	Executive Team + Podcast Moderator	Latino Christian leaders collective. Founder/President: Rev. David Ramos. Other execs: Rev. Dr. Luis Alvarez, Rev. Dr. Orlando Crespo, Elder Belinda Passafaro.
Christian Church (Disciples of Christ)	Commission on Ministry member	Denominational governance
Freedom Road (Lisa Sharon Harper)	Senior Consultant & Special Projects	Racial justice consultancy
Urban Strategies	Co-vocational leader (20+ years)	Community development / ministry formation
R.E.A.L. Black Women in Ministry THRIVE initiative	Senior Mentor (4+ years)	BIPOC women in ministry formation
Fuller Theological Seminary	Adjunct Faculty	Church planting / missiology (CPI orbit)
Outreach Magazine	Consulting Editor	Since 2008

Prior / former board + leadership

Org	Role	Notes
National Latino Evangelical Coalition (NaLEC)	Board member	Panelist at 2018 Summit with Ed Stetzer
Evangelicals for Social Action	Advisory board	
Nyack College	Asst. Professor of Christian Education + Exec. Director of Advancement	mid-2000s
Primitive Christian Church (PCC), NYC	Credentialed by Assemblies of God	Early ministry credentialing
Latino Pastoral Action Center (LPAC)	Mentored by Bishop Raymond Rivera	Early formation

Partner organizations (via Passion2Plant)

- **CBE International** — Women and The Church course partnership
- **Faith-based Latino Mental Health Hub**
- **Christianity Today** — Black & Evangelical partnership
- **P2P Seminary Now** — in-house learning platform

Denominational / ecumenical memberships

- Christian Church (Disciples of Christ) — ordination home
- Pentecostals and Charismatics for Peace and Justice (PCPJ) — contributing author
- MLK Jr. College of Ministers and Laity Board of Preachers (2023 induction)
- Florida College of Preachers, Palm Beach Atlantic University — inaugural inductee (Oct 2025, only woman)

Sorority / civic

- Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc. — 39-year member; charter member, South Broward Alumnae Chapter

Audience & Reach

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/analysis/audience-analysis.md

status: empty

sidebar: audience-profile

Websites

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/digital-presence/websites.md

Web properties

Owned domains

Domain	Purpose	Notes
elizabethrios.com	Personal brand site	Bio, books, media, testimonials, Latinas of Legacy. Primary author platform.
thepassioncenter.org	Training center + community	Organizational home for her teaching.
passion2plant.com	Church planting network	Cohort applications, values, partner list.

Publishing Platforms

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/digital-presence/platforms.md`

Platforms & publishing

Podcast platforms

- Hosts / moderates: **Latino Leadership Circle Podcast** (Apple Podcasts)
- Featured series on her own channels: Cafecito Conversations, Latinas of Legacy, Passion2Plant Mentor Moment

Email / contact

- `drlizrios@gmail.com` (public personal)
- `erios@urbanstrategies.us` (Púlpito Fellows program)
- Mail: P.O. Box 580527, Kissimmee, FL 34758

Academic profiles

- Academia.edu: `independentresearcher.academia.edu/ElizabethRios` and `seuniversity.academia.edu/ElizabethRios`

Amazon author page

- `amazon.com/stores/author/B00B1R43M2`

Platform health assessment (subjective)

Surface	Assessment	Gap / opportunity
Personal site	Comprehensive but static — reads like a portfolio, not a content engine	Could benefit from a full pillar-page architecture and corpus-backed RAG
Substack + Medium	Actively publishing but split brand across two platforms	Consolidation or cross-post automation
YouTube (two channels)	Active but low-production; content captured at events	Editorial cadence + Púlpito Fellows archive could anchor a searchable library
Podcast footprint	Very high guest velocity — she is a repeat guest in multiple networks	Own hosted feed for her work is under-developed
Search footprint	Strong under "Liz Rios" + "Elizabeth Rios" pastor variants; some name-collision risk with academics of similar name	Canonical identity anchor (Wikipedia-style or schema.org Person) would help

Movemental-fit signals from the digital footprint

- She already **treats the web as pulpit** (Púlpito Fellows thesis). The platform's Content System Build is an exact fit for her own stated program deliverables ("three digital products per fellow").
- She has the **authored corpus volume** (articles, dissertations, chapters, podcasts) to make RAG + voice-agent work materially useful — she is past the cold-start problem.
- Her audience **does not currently have a first-class author platform** representing Latina Pentecostal / mujerista voice at Hirsch-tier production quality. Movemental can be that platform for her.

Newsletters

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/digital-presence/newsletters.md

Newsletters

Newsletter / long-form writing

- **Substack** — Mujerista in Motion (handle: [drlizrios](#))
- **Medium** — [drlizrios.medium.com](#)

Both are active, she writes under both flags. Confirm subscriber counts via direct contact; not public.

Social Media

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/digital-presence/social-media.md

Social media

Social handles (confirmed)

- Facebook — @thepassioncenter and personal
- Instagram — @thepassioncenter
- YouTube — @thepassioncenter (The Passion Center channel)
- YouTube — **Púlpito Voices** (separate channel for Púlpito Fellows program)
- LinkedIn — drlizrios — listed title: "Urban Strategies"
- X/Twitter — presence likely but not prominent in search results (verify)

The Fragmentation Story

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/fragmentation-story.md

Liz Rios: The Fragmentation Story

Generated 2026-05-20 by inline synthesis from existing dossier files (no upstream fragmentation-story skill run).

The Story

Rev. Dr. Elizabeth "Liz" D. Rios has carried thirty-five-plus years of ministry through pastoring, planting, teaching, consulting, and editing — and into infrastructure. She founded **Passion2Plant** in 2020, the only national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network in the United States, with three named cohort tracks (Just Church, Trauma, Pulpito Fellows). She directs **Pulpito Fellows**, a three-year Lilly Endowment-funded bilingual preaching fellowship at Urban Strategies, running 10-week cohorts (one 1.5-day in-person launch plus eight Zoom sessions) coordinated with Rev. Aracelis Vasquez Haye, whose explicit deliverable is "three digital products per fellow." She founded and curates **The Passion Center**, an online missional community and training platform, and her earliest flagship — the Center for Emerging Female Leadership in NYC — ran from 1996 to 2001. She holds a BA, MA, EdD from Nova Southeastern (dissertation: Evaluating Transformative Spirituality in an Organizational Leadership Program at a Christian University), a DMin from Southeastern (dissertation: Developing Civically Engaged, Justice Oriented Churches Right From the Start), and a 2025 MA in Social Justice from Union Theological Seminary. She is ordained Christian Church (Disciples of Christ), serves on its Commission on Ministry, was previously credentialed Assemblies of God through Primitive Christian Church, NYC. She sits on the board of Sojourners, on the executive team of the Latino Leadership Circle (with Rev. David Ramos, Rev. Dr. Luis Alvarez, Rev. Dr. Orlando Crespo, Elder Belinda Passafaro), as senior consultant at Lisa Sharon Harper's Freedom Road, as adjunct faculty at Fuller Theological Seminary, as senior mentor in the R.E.A.L. Black Women in Ministry THRIVE initiative, as consulting editor at Outreach Magazine since 2008, and as a co-vocational leader at Urban Strategies for 20+ years. In October 2025 she became the only woman inducted into Palm Beach Atlantic University's inaugural Florida College of Preachers.

That is a stunning amount of codified, durable work. And yet the picture that emerges from the dossier is of a Latina pastor-scholar-operator whose **owned digital surface area is split across three domains, two newsletters, two YouTube channels, one hosted podcast, and an audience that does not yet have a first-class author platform representing Afro-Boricua mujerista voice at production-quality scale**. She runs elizabethrios.com (personal brand, reads like a static portfolio), thepassioncenter.org (training center), and passion2plant.com (cohort network) — three sites, no canonical hub. She writes under two

flags — Substack Mujerista in Motion (handle [drlizrios](#)) and Medium [drlizrios.medium.com](#) — without cross-post automation. She runs two YouTube presences — The Passion Center channel ([@thepassioncenter](#)) and the separate **Púlpito Voices** channel for the fellowship — both low-production, mostly event capture, neither editorially sequenced. Her hosted podcast work is the Latino Leadership Circle Podcast (moderator role); her guest velocity is high — Be the Bridge with Latasha Morrison, The Mestizo Podcast with Emanuel Padilla, The Protagonistas with Kat Armas, Right Side Up with Danielle Strickland, And the Church Said, The Church Planting Podcast with Greg Nettle and Len Tang, Ephesiology, the COGIC Hispanic Initiatives Podcast with John Edward Perez and Dr. Eli Valentín, and more — but the canonical archive of her own hosted feed is under-developed.

And even the public-facing layer is fractured. She is a contributor to **100 Movements Publishing's** *Need to Know* (2023, curated by Danielle Strickland, alongside Alan Hirsch, Scot McKnight, Jo Saxton, Lisa Rodriguez-Watson, Beth Allison Barr, Mandy Smith, Bob Ekblad, and Lori Anne Thompson). She is sole author of *Don't Buy The Lie: Eradicating False Belief Systems That Keep You From Your Destiny* (Ghetto Rose Publications, 2012). She is co-curator with Amb. Suzan Johnson Cook on *Rhythms of Rest: 40 Devotions for Women on the Move* (Our Daily Bread). She wrote "The Women are Warriors" for Oxford University Press's *Latino Religions and Civic Activism in the United States*, reprinted in the *Azusa Street and Beyond* centennial volume. She publishes columns in *Sojourners*, *Christianity Today*, *Influence*, *Called Magazine*, *PCPJ*, *Red Letter Christians*, *Latin Business Today*, *The Atlantic*, *The Washington Post*, and *Religion News Service* — none of it indexed back to a single canonical hub. Her bilingual register (Púlpito, Cafecito, Madrinas, Latinas of Legacy, Mujerista) is a primary brand signal, but no platform she uses today treats Spanish-English code-switching as a first-class concern. Her audience is being served everywhere and nowhere.

Informational Fragmentation

Books

Sole-authored, contributed, and curated:

1. **Don't Buy The Lie: Eradicating False Belief Systems That Keep You From Your Destiny** — Ghetto Rose Publications, 2012 — sole author. Audiobook status: UNKNOWN — needs research.
2. **Need to Know: Empowering Female Leadership and Why It's Essential for the Future of the Church** — 100 Movements Publishing (Alan Hirsch's imprint), 2023 — contributor (21-voice collection curated by Danielle Strickland). Co-contributors: Alan Hirsch, Scot McKnight, Jo Saxton, Lisa Rodriguez-Watson, Beth Allison Barr, Mandy Smith, Bob Ekblad, Lori Anne Thompson.
3. **Rhythms of Rest: 40 Devotions for Women on the Move** — Our Daily Bread Publishing — contributor + co-book-curator (with Amb. Suzan Johnson Cook); contributors drawn from Black and multicultural communities. Year: UNKNOWN — needs research.

Retail footprint: Amazon author page amazon.com/stores/author/B00B1R43M2 . Specific ISBNs and product URLs not captured.

Academic Work

- **EdD, Nova Southeastern University** — dissertation: Evaluating Transformative Spirituality in an Organizational Leadership Program at a Christian University — published at nsuworks.nova.edu.
- **DMin, Southeastern University** — dissertation: Developing Civically Engaged, Justice Oriented Churches Right From the Start — published at firescholars.seu.edu.
- **MA in Social Justice, Union Theological Seminary** — graduated May 2025. Thesis title: UNKNOWN — needs research.
- **Scholarly chapter**: "The Women are Warriors" in Latino Religions and Civic Activism in the United States (Oxford University Press), reprinted in Azusa Street and Beyond: 100 Years of Commentary on the Global/Pentecostal Charismatic Movement.
- **Encyclopedic entries**: Encyclopedia of Women and Religion in North America, Vol. 1 (2006); Latinas in the United States: A Historical Encyclopedia (2006).
- **Peer-reviewed journal articles** beyond the above: UNKNOWN — needs research.
- **Academic profiles**: independentresearcher.academia.edu/ElizabethRios and seuniversity.academia.edu/ElizabethRios .
- **Research / survey committees**: LifeWay Research Hispanic Church Planting Report (survey of 218 new church works) committee member; Hidden Figures: Celebrating Pentecostal Women; Women in Ministry Study; Latinas of Legacy; Justice Oriented Churches.

PDFs / Documents

- Two dissertations (above) as institutional repository PDFs.
- Pulpito Fellows curriculum and digital-product artifacts (three per fellow per cohort): UNKNOWN — needs research on whether these are aggregated as a downloadable corpus.
- Passion2Plant cohort design documents (Just Church, Trauma, Pulpito): UNKNOWN — likely internal only.
- Hispanic Church Planting Report contributions: UNKNOWN public PDF availability.

Articles

Selected outlets — full archive pull not yet completed:

- **Sojourners** — "The Urgent Need for Justice-Oriented Churches in the U.S."; "Latino Evangelicals Say NO to the Death Penalty" (Jul 2015).
- **Send Institute** — "COVID-19's Burden on the Black and Brown Church" (2020).
- **Influence Magazine** — "Church Dropouts" (series).

- **Christianity Today** — "Why Latino Christians Treasure January 6."
- **PCPJ (Pentecostals and Charismatics for Peace and Justice)** — "Justice as Electoral Praxis: Hope for Florida, Latina Evangelicas and Election 2020" (2020); author archive at pcpj.org/author/revdrlizrios.
- **Red Letter Christians** — "Faith Is on the Ballot: A Call for the Latino Vote."
- **Called Magazine** — "Are we Called to Confront?"
- **Medium** — "The Intersection of Womanist and Mujerista Theology in Embracing Diasporic Afro-Latina Women."
- **Voyage Tampa** — "Conversations with Elizabeth Rios."
- **Latin Business Today** — ongoing small-business column.
- Additional outlets listed on elizabethrios.com/media: The Atlantic, The Washington Post, Religion News Service, PRISM Magazine.

Estimated volume: 40+ known, archive-complete figure likely 100+ across a 20-year writing career.

Blogs & Personal Writing

- **Substack** — Mujerista in Motion (handle [drlizrios](https://substack.com/@drlizrios)). Subscriber count not public.
- **Medium** — drlizrios.medium.com. Subscriber count not public.
- **The Passion Center** — thepassioncenter.org (own platform) — long-form writing and news posts (e.g., the Florida College of Preachers induction announcement).
- No unified cross-post automation between Substack and Medium.

Websites

Owned / personal

- elizabethrios.com — personal brand site (bio, books, media, testimonials, Latinas of Legacy). Subpages: [/about](#), [/books](#), [/media](#), [/what-others-say-about-dr-liz](#), [/latinas-of-legacy](#).
- thepassioncenter.org — training center + community. User pages: [/users/rev-dr-elizabeth-rios](#) and [/users/dr-elizabeth-rios](#).
- passion2plant.com — church planting network. Key page: [/who-we-are](#).

Organizations she founded or directs (external URLs)

- urbanstrategies.us/programs/pulpito-fellows-program — Pulpito Fellows program page.

Affiliated (she appears on but does not control)

- Sojourners — sojo.net/biography/elizabeth-d-rios.
- Freedom Road — freedomroad.us/who-we-are/rev-dr-liz-rios.
- Latino Leadership Circle — latinoleadershipcircle.org.
- PCPJ author archive — pcpj.org/author/revdrlizrios.
- 100 Movements Publishing — 100mpublishing.com/product/need-to-know.
- Fuller Church Planting Initiative — churchplanting.fuller.edu.

Social Media

Platform	Handle	Status
Facebook	@thepassioncenter + personal profile	Confirmed
Instagram	@thepassioncenter	Confirmed
YouTube — The Passion Center	@thepassioncenter	Confirmed
YouTube — Pulpito Voices	separate channel for Pulpito Fellows	Confirmed
LinkedIn	drlizrios (listed title: "Urban Strategies")	Confirmed
X / Twitter	UNKNOWN — needs research (presence likely but not prominent in search)	—
TikTok	UNKNOWN — needs research	—
Threads / Bluesky	UNKNOWN — needs research	—

Follower counts and posting cadence: not measured in this pass.

Newsletters / Email

- **Substack** Mujerista in Motion — drlizrios — active, subscriber count not public.
- **Medium** drlizrios.medium.com — active, subscriber count not public.
- Whether elizabethrios.com, thepassioncenter.org, or passion2plant.com capture independent newsletter signups: UNKNOWN — needs research.
- Whether Passion2Plant or Pulpito Fellows operates a cohort-internal newsletter to fellows and alumni: UNKNOWN — needs research.
- Public contact emails: drlizrios@gmail.com (personal); erios@urbanstrategies.us (Pulpito Fellows program). Mailing: P.O. Box 580527, Kissimmee, FL 34758.

Podcasts Hosted

- **Latino Leadership Circle Podcast** (Apple Podcasts) — moderator role.

Podcasts Guested (Selected)

- Be the Bridge with Latasha Morrison — "Leaders of Color: Latinx with Dr. Elizabeth Rios."
- The Mestizo Podcast with Emanuel Padilla — "Loving DJ."
- The Protagonistas with Kat Armas — "Theology in El Barrio."
- The Black Church Still Speaks — Multiethnic Ministry & Women in Leadership.
- Ephesiology Podcast — "Disciples Learn" / "Make Disciples" series.
- Right Side Up (Danielle Strickland) — Need to Know Episode 10, co-guest with Lisa Rodriguez-Watson.

- And the Church Said — "Passion2Plant with Dr. Liz Rios."
- The Church Planting Podcast — with Greg Nettle and Len Tang.
- COGIC Hispanic Initiatives — with John Edward Perez and Dr. Eli Valentín.
- Two Mothers, One Aché — Grief and Religion.
- JustUs Talks with José Humphreys — "Seeing Jesus in East Harlem."
- Elevate Life with Dieula Previlon — grief / loss conversation.
- Buried Talents with Dr. Susan Harris Howell.
- Christians Under the Covers with Sheila Wray Gregoire.
- HSP Exchange Feminista Chats with Daisy Machado.
- Calling in Context with Dr. Susan Maros.
- Bold Journey feature — "Meet Rev. Dr. Elizabeth Rios" (boldjourney.com).

Total: 15+ guest appearances, with ongoing recurrence.

Videos / YouTube

Own video series:

- Cafecito Conversations — Madrinas · Sisterhood Alliances · Lessons from our Fathers.
- Latinas of Legacy.
- Passion2Plant Mentor Moment — "Lessons from 40 Years of Ministry."
- "Women in Church Planting: Imposter Syndrome."
- Interview series with Daniel Yang, Dr. Susan Maros, Dr. Susan Harris Howell, Sheila Wray Gregoire.

Conference / lecture video — likely exists but archive presence uncatalogued for: 4th Annual Mama Leo Lecture Series at Union Theological Seminary (2024, "Prophetic Legacy: Latina Voices Shaping Church and Society"); HESD gathering at Austin Theological Seminary ("Prophetic Leadership for a Liberated Tomorrow"); Fuller Missiology Lectures 2023 response with Daniel Yang, Len Tang, Dr. Soong-Chan Rah; Wheaton College (Billy Graham Center) June 2020 talk Holistic & Locally Present Engagement During Pandemic; episode "Micro & Multiethnic Churches & the Future of Church Planting" on YouTube (youtube.com/watch?v=TRg7XSr12jk).

Courses / Workshops

- **Púlpito Fellows** — 3-year fellowship, 10-week bilingual cohorts (1.5-day in-person launch + 8 Zoom sessions), each fellow produces 3 digital products. Cohorts run: Spring 2024 (Cohort 1), Fall 2024 (Cohort 2), 2025 (Cohort 3).
- **Passion2Plant Just Church cohort** — track inside Passion2Plant.
- **Passion2Plant Trauma cohort** — track inside Passion2Plant.
- **P2P Seminary Now** — Passion2Plant's in-house learning platform.

- **CBE International — Women and The Church** course partnership (via Passion2Plant).
- **Urban Ministry Conferences at Nyack College** (mid-2000s, founder/convener) — drew hundreds of urban missiologists; current status unclear.
- Self-hosted course on a mainstream platform (Teachable / Thinkific / Kajabi): UNKNOWN — needs research.

Assessments / Tools

- None discovered as a personal proprietary instrument.
- Diagnostic instruments embedded inside Passion2Plant cohort onboarding: UNKNOWN — needs research.

Unpublished / Internal Material

- Pulpito Fellows curriculum and weekly session decks across three cohorts.
- Three digital-product artifacts per fellow per cohort — likely a substantial unpublished media archive.
- Passion2Plant cohort facilitation notes (Just Church, Trauma, Pulpito).
- Coaching / mentorship notes from R.E.A.L. THRIVE (4+ years senior mentor role).
- Freedom Road consulting project documents (Senior Consultant & Special Projects since 2008).
- Sojourners board materials.
- Disciples of Christ Commission on Ministry deliberation notes.
- Outreach Magazine consulting editor correspondence (since 2008).
- Mama Leo Lecture full text (Union, 2024) — UNKNOWN whether publicly archived in full.
- Daniel-memorial reflections (her son Daniel, who had special needs, transitioned 9/22/2022 at age 23) — explicitly off-limits without her direct approval.
- 35 years of sermon manuscripts, bilingual where applicable.

Relational Fragmentation

Organizations Co-Founded or Led

- **Passion2Plant** (2020–present) — founder; only national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network in the U.S.
- **The Passion Center** (~2020–present) — founder & community curator.
- **Center for Emerging Female Leadership** (NYC, 1996–2001) — founder; closed 2001.
- **Urban Ministry Conferences at Nyack College** (mid-2000s) — founder / convener.
- **Pulpito Fellows** (2024–present) — director (program inside Urban Strategies, partnership with Passion2Plant).

Affiliated Organizations (Current Boards & Leadership)

- **Sojourners** — board member.
- **Latino Leadership Circle** — executive team + podcast moderator. Founder/president: Rev. David Ramos. Other execs: Rev. Dr. Luis Alvarez, Rev. Dr. Orlando Crespo, Elder Belinda Passafaro.
- **Christian Church (Disciples of Christ)** — Commission on Ministry member.
- **Freedom Road (Lisa Sharon Harper)** — Senior Consultant & Special Projects.
- **Urban Strategies** — co-vocational leader (20+ years connection).
- **R.E.A.L. Black Women in Ministry THRIVE** — senior mentor (4+ years).
- **Fuller Theological Seminary** — adjunct faculty (Church Planting Initiative orbit).
- **Outreach Magazine** — consulting editor since 2008.
- **MLK Jr. College of Ministers and Laity, Board of Preachers** (inducted 2023).
- **Florida College of Preachers, Palm Beach Atlantic University** — inaugural inductee, only woman (Oct 2025).

Affiliated Organizations (Prior)

- **National Latino Evangelical Coalition (NaLEC)** — board member; panelist at 2018 Summit with Ed Stetzer.
- **Evangelicals for Social Action** — advisory board.
- **Nyack College** — Assistant Professor of Christian Education + Executive Director of Advancement.
- **Primitive Christian Church (PCC), NYC** — early AG credentialing.
- **Latino Pastoral Action Center (LPAC)** — mentored by Bishop Raymond Rivera.

Partner Organizations via Passion2Plant

- **CBE International** — Women and The Church course partnership.
- **Faith-based Latino Mental Health Hub.**
- **Christianity Today** — Black & Evangelical partnership.
- **P2P Seminary Now** — in-house learning platform.

Co-authors and Collaborators

- **Alan Hirsch** — co-contributor on Need to Know (100 Movements Publishing, 2023). Direct correspondence relationship: UNKNOWN — open question.
- **Danielle Strickland** — Need to Know curator; hosted Rios on Right Side Up Episode 10. **Strong** direct repeat collaboration.
- **Lisa Rodriguez-Watson** — Need to Know co-contributor; co-guest on Right Side Up Ep. 10. **Strong** shared platform.

- **Scot McKnight, Jo Saxton, Beth Allison Barr, Mandy Smith, Bob Ekblad, Lori Anne Thompson** — Need to Know co-contributors.
- **Amb. Suzan Johnson Cook** — co-curator on Rhythms of Rest; presented her Unsung Sheroe Award (2023).
- **Lisa Sharon Harper** — Freedom Road founder; she is Senior Consultant there.

Networks and Movements

- **100 Movements Publishing / Forge orbit** — Need to Know contributor.
- **Sojourners / Freedom Road / Red Letter Christians / PCPJ / Evangelicals for Social Action** — justice-oriented ecumenical cluster.
- **Latino Pentecostal NYC lineage** — PCC, LPAC, NaLEC, Latino Leadership Circle.
- **Fuller Church Planting Initiative** orbit — Len Tang, Daniel Yang, Soong-Chan Rah.
- **Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc.** — 39-year member; charter member, South Broward Alumnae Chapter.

Academic Affiliations

- Nova Southeastern University (EdD).
- Southeastern University (DMin).
- Union Theological Seminary (MA Social Justice 2025; Mama Leo Lecture Series).
- Fuller Theological Seminary (adjunct faculty).
- Nyack College (former Assistant Professor of Christian Education + Executive Director of Advancement).
- Palm Beach Atlantic University — Florida College of Preachers (inaugural inductee 2025).
- Southeastern University (additional Academia.edu profile).

Mentors and Protégés

- **Mentors / formational figures:** Bishop Raymond Rivera (LPAC, foundational mentor); Leoncia "Mama Leo" Rosado Rousseau (NYC's first Latina pastor, named ancestor); Ada María Isasi-Díaz (mujerista lineage); Amb. Suzan Johnson Cook (continuing relationship).
- **Named endorsers** (from elizabethrios.com/what-others-say): Dr. Suzan Johnson Cook, Brian McLaren, Kristyn Komarnicki (former PRISM Magazine editor / Christians for Social Action), Rev. Dr. Marc Rivera (Senior Pastor PCC, NYC), Fernando Arzola Jr., PhD (former Associate Dean, Nyack), Lisa Sharon Harper, Rev. Dr. Michael Carrion (Promised Land Covenant Church / Redeemer City to City), Dr. Dale Dan (Joy-at-Work Center), Dr. Robert Chao Romero (UCLA; Brown Church), Rich Robinson (Forge / 100 Movements adjacent), Daniel Yang (World Relief), Bishop Raymond Rivera.

- **Protégés:** Pulpito Fellows cohorts (3 cohorts since Spring 2024, with coordinator Rev. Aracelis Vasquez Haye); Passion2Plant Just Church and Trauma cohort participants; R.E.A.L. Black Women in Ministry THRIVE mentees (4+ years).
- **Family / kin: Rev. Hiram Rios** — husband, co-ministry partner, 35+ years married. Sons Samuel and Daniel (Daniel had special needs, transitioned 9/22/2022 at age 23).

Where Relationships Are Actually Stored

- **Inside Urban Strategies' staff systems and Lilly Endowment reporting infrastructure** (Pulpito Fellows program rosters and outcomes).
- **Inside Passion2Plant cohort applications and partner list** (passion2plant.com/who-we-are).
- **Inside The Passion Center user profile system** (thepassioncenter.org/users/...).
- **Inside Sojourners' board systems and Freedom Road's consulting CRM.**
- **Latino Leadership Circle internal lists** and executive team correspondence.
- **Disciples of Christ Commission on Ministry rosters.**
- **R.E.A.L. THRIVE mentorship rosters.**
- **Outreach Magazine editorial contact lists** (since 2008).
- **Conference attendee lists:** NaLEC Summit, CPLF2019 Gathering (Wheaton), Latino-American Church Planting Think Tank (Feb 2020), Fuller Missiology Lectures, HESD Austin Theological, Wheaton/Billy Graham Center, Florida College of Preachers induction (Oct 2025).
- **Personal email** drlizrios@gmail.com and program email erios@urbanstrategies.us — the largest likely store of long-standing relational continuity.
- **Substack subscriber list** ([drlizrios](#) Substack admin).
- **Mental rolodex** — 35+ years of Latino Pentecostal NYC + Disciples of Christ + ecumenical justice + 100 Movements relationships.
- **No unified personal CRM** observed across the three owned domains.

Embodied / In-Their-Head Layer

- **The pragmatic wisdom of being the only BIPOC-woman-led national church planting network founder in the U.S.** — what to say to a Latina pastor who has been told her call is impossible by the network that trained her; how to triage trauma, food insecurity, and systemic neglect inside a launch timeline. She narrates Passion2Plant's founding precisely as a response to networks that "did not prepare me for the real challenges I faced as a BIPOC woman planting a church in a community marked by poverty, systemic neglect, and food insecurity" — that judgment runs cohort decisions, not policy documents.

- **The judgment calls behind the disrupt/cultivate mission grammar of Passion2Plant** — which oppressive systems to name on which Tuesday, which cultivation moves to pair with which disruption.
- **The bilingual register decisions** — which Spanish terms to leave untranslated (Pulpito, Cafecito, Madrinass, Mujerista), which to gloss, when to code-switch in the same paragraph. This is identity performance, not ornament.
- **The curation logic of Pulpito Fellows** — who to invite into a 3-year fellowship, who to admit to a 10-week cohort, how to sequence in-person + Zoom + product-artifact loops, what counts as a "digital product" for a Latina/o preacher.
- **The decision discipline of being a triple-doctored woman of color** — EdD + DMin + Union MA — earned to be heard. What that costs, when to lead with credentials and when to lead with story.
- **Daniel-shaped reflections** — explicitly off-limits without her direct approval. The voice-fidelity guardrail names this directly.
- **The named-accountability rhetorical move** — when to name Samuel Rodriguez, when to name Christian Nationalism, when to name the specific networks that failed her, when to name Mama Leo, Bishop Rivera, or Suzan Johnson Cook as honor. The naming is theology, not commentary.
- **The Mama Leo Lecture preparation** at Union (4th Annual, 2024) — the choices behind "Prophetic Legacy: Latina Voices Shaping Church and Society."
- **Coffee shop and Cafecito conversations** — the Cafecito Conversations show name is the public-facing icon of an underlying practice — Madrinass, sisterhood alliances, lessons from fathers — held in living rooms and kitchens with Aracelis Vasquez Haye, with Suzan Johnson Cook, with the Latino Leadership Circle executive team, with Rev. Hiram Rios.
- **The rooms:** Sojourners board meetings · Latino Leadership Circle executive sessions · Disciples of Christ Commission on Ministry deliberations · Freedom Road consulting calls with Lisa Sharon Harper · Fuller CPI faculty rooms · the Florida College of Preachers induction (Palm Beach Atlantic, Oct 2025, as the only woman in the inaugural class) · Mama Leo Lecture greenrooms at Union · Pulpito Fellows in-person launch weekends · the P.O. Box 580527 desk in Kissimmee, FL.

Synthesis

Liz Rios's fragmentation is **not** the generic shape of "your work is scattered." It is the precise shape of **an Afro-Boricua mujerista pastor-scholar-operator running a national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network and a Lilly-funded bilingual preaching fellowship from three uncoordinated owned domains, two newsletters, two YouTube channels, one moderator-only podcast, and a guest-velocity speaking calendar that everyone else's audience benefits from before her own does.** The Pulpito Fellows program already has the cohort architecture, the bilingual register, the funding structure, the explicit deliverable ("three digital products per fellow"), and the editorial

coordinator (Rev. Aracelis Vasquez Haye) — but the artifacts those fellows produce do not yet roll up into a searchable, sequenced, *mujerista*-voiced corpus indexed at elizabethrios.com or thepassioncenter.org or passion2plant.com or any fourth canonical hub. Her authored corpus — Don't Buy The Lie, the Need to Know contribution alongside Alan Hirsch and Danielle Strickland and Lisa Rodriguez-Watson, the Rhythms of Rest co-curation with Suzan Johnson Cook, the Oxford "Women are Warriors" chapter, the two dissertations, the Sojourners and CT and PCPJ and Influence columns, the *Mujerista* in Motion Substack, the Cafecito Conversations and Latinas of Legacy and Passion2Plant Mentor Moment video series, the Mama Leo Lecture at Union — has the volume to make RAG and voice-fidelity tooling materially useful. She is past the cold-start problem. What she does not yet have is **one canonical Latina Pentecostal *mujerista* author platform that treats Spanish-English code-switching as first-class, indexes the corpus across the three domains and two newsletters, and turns Pulpito Fellows' "three digital products per fellow" into a sequenced public library** rather than a per-cohort scatter.

The diagnosis is precise: a diasporic Afro-Boricua bilingual cohort-operator's authority is scattered across institutional pulpits she does not own — Sojourners, Freedom Road, Outreach, Need to Know, Union, Fuller, Palm Beach Atlantic, Lilly, Urban Strategies, the Latino Leadership Circle, Disciples of Christ — with no central searchable hub that her own audience can return to in either language.

Research Provenance

- **Source folder:** `/home/josh/dev/01-Movemental-Core/movemental-ai/docs/movement_leader_research/liz-rios/`
- **Files read:**
 - `README.md`
 - `_tracker.md`
 - `summary.md`
 - `committed-voice.md`
 - `digital-presence.md`
 - `movemental-analysis.md`
 - `sources.md`
 - `content/content-audit.md`
 - `network/affiliations.md`
 - `network/endorsers.md`
 - `network/movemental-overlap.md`
 - `profile/biography.md`
 - `profile/identity.md`
 - `profile/voice-analysis.md`

- **Mirror file consulted for identity row:** `/home/josh/dev/01-Movemental-Core/movemental-visual-editor-main/docs/movement_leader_research/liz-rios.md`
- **Template followed:** `/home/josh/dev/01-Movemental-Core/movemental-ai/docs/movement_leader_research/brad-brisco/fragmentation-story.md`
- **Confidence: High** for organizational roles (Passion2Plant founder, Pulpito Fellows director, Sojourners board, Freedom Road consultant, Fuller adjunct, Outreach consulting editor, Florida College of Preachers inductee), book footprint (Don't Buy The Lie, Need to Know, Rhythms of Rest, Oxford "Women are Warriors" chapter), two dissertations, Union MA 2025, three owned domains, dual Substack/Medium presence, two YouTube channels, hosted Latino Leadership Circle Podcast, named endorsers and Need to Know co-contributor list, Latino Leadership Circle executive team. **Medium** for podcast guest episode metadata (some dates and episode numbers not captured), Spanish-language audience split, Pulpito Fellows artifact distribution mechanism. **Low** for X / TikTok / Threads / Bluesky presence, full Sojourners / Influence / CT article inventory, audiobook status of any title, Union MA thesis title, direct Alan Hirsch correspondence status, Passion2Plant funder mix beyond Lilly, technical stack of the three owned domains.
- **Top open questions** carried forward from `_tracker.md` and `movemental-analysis.md`: direct Alan Hirsch relationship; willingness to engage AI voice-agent tooling given mujerista authenticity commitments; Spanish-content strategy depth; whether she is shopping for a platform or settled on existing stack; Passion2Plant tech stack and staff; budget authority and decision-maker identity (Passion2Plant org vs. personal brand vs. Urban Strategies).

A Letter — Reflected Understanding

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/reflected-understanding/liz-rios.md

Liz Rios: Reflected Understanding

A concise reflection spoken back so the language could be endorsed — familiar, but with edges that deepen. (Leader-safe: audience-sizing and commerce analysis are kept in staff notes, not here.)

Calling

You're called to **prepare a pulpit for those the field was not built for**. Not to start one more church planting network for its own sake, but to retrain the discipline itself from the margins — so that Latina, Black, and bivocational women of color don't have to plant churches inside curricula written around assumptions that were never theirs. When you say it plainly, the language is disrupt and cultivate: disrupt the oppressive systems and the attractional, church-growth defaults you were trained inside, and cultivate faith spaces of transformation in their place. That has been the through-line for thirty-five years — from the **Center for Emerging Female Leadership** you founded in New York (1996–2001) to mentor emerging women ministers, through your pastoring and consulting, into **Passion2Plant**, the only national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network in the United States, and into **Pulpito Fellows**, the Lilly Endowment-funded bilingual preaching fellowship you direct. Your theology gives this calling its weight: a *mujerista* and *barrio* theology that reasons from the lived experience of Latinas, a justice-oriented ecclesiology that treats civic engagement as constitutive of church planting rather than an add-on, and a conviction that women's leadership is an ecclesiological and eschatological question, not an HR one. You name the exclusions explicitly because you lived them — planting in a community marked by poverty, systemic neglect, and food insecurity, with no network that had prepared you for it. The calling is to make sure the next woman is prepared. You're not building a brand; you're authoring the curriculum the field forgot to write.

Existing Content (before the platform we're building)

Where it lives. Your content lives in **books and chapters** — *Don't Buy The Lie* (2012), your contribution to *Need to Know* with 100 Movements Publishing (2023) alongside Alan Hirsch, Scot McKnight, Jo Saxton, and Lisa Rodriguez-Watson, the co-curated *Rhythms of Rest* with *Our Daily Bread*, and "The Women are Warriors" in Oxford University Press's volume on Latino religion and civic activism. It lives in **dissertations and academic work** (an EdD from Nova Southeastern, a DMin from Southeastern, a 2025 MA in Social Justice from Union). It lives in

columns across Sojourners, Christianity Today, Influence, PCPJ, Red Letter Christians, and Religion News Service; in **long-form writing** split between your Mujerista in Motion Substack and your Medium archive; in **video and audio** across The Passion Center channel, the separate Pulpito Voices channel, Cafecito Conversations, and Latinas of Legacy; and in **high guest velocity** — repeat appearances on other people's podcasts and networks. Your owned teaching is distributed across three sites: elizabethrios.com, thepassioncenter.org, and passion2plant.com.

Credibility. It's high and well-attested. Adjunct faculty at Fuller; board member at Sojourners; executive team of the Latino Leadership Circle; senior consultant with Freedom Road; consulting editor at Outreach Magazine; the only woman inducted into Palm Beach Atlantic's inaugural Florida College of Preachers. The authority is not in question. The issue is **visibility, connection, and reuse**.

How it lives online now. As **silos**. The book sits on its Amazon page; the Need to Know chapter on the publisher's site; the Oxford chapter inside Oxford's catalog; the columns each on their host platform's surface; the writing split across two newsletters with no cross-post tissue; the video across two uncoordinated channels. There is no single place where "everything Liz has written and said about mujerista theology, justice-focused church planting, and the digital pulpit" is structured, linked, and findable. Pulpito Fellows artifacts — each fellow's "three digital products," the session decks, the cohort debriefs — live inside program and reporting systems rather than in any public, searchable archive. So the work doesn't **move**: it stays where it was first placed.

The NOTs the platform addresses directly. Your content is largely **not** consolidated under one surface you control; **not** structured and repurposed so a fellowship becomes a public sequenced course and a chapter becomes a pathway; **not** interconnected so the DMin thesis, the Sojourners column, the Need to Know essay, and the Pulpito curriculum visibly reference each other; **not** served by an AI that reflects your voice and corpus; **not** optimized so searchers for "Latina church planting," "mujerista theology," or "justice-focused church" find your material first; and **not** yet doing this work **bilingually**, in the English-and-Spanish register your audience actually reads in. The platform is built to speak to each of these — consolidation, structure and repurpose, interconnection, an AI that serves your voice, bilingual discoverability, and ownership — so your content can move.

Constraints

Leaders carrying mDNA priorities live under **time** and **money** constraints that are emblematic, not personal failure. You're directing a three-year fellowship, founding and running a national planting network, teaching at Fuller, consulting, sitting on boards, and writing across multiple outlets — co-vocationally. Time for content strategy, for repurposing talks and cohort sessions into articles and courses, or for building a unified bilingual digital home is scarce because the work is in the room: in cohort calls, at Cafecito tables, in

classrooms, with the Latina planters your role exists to serve. There is also the particular care your *mujerista* commitment to authenticity demands — content that represents you cannot be flattened or generic; voice and register matter. The desire to reach every leader God has given you is there; the hours to do it at scale, in both languages and every format, typically are not. A platform that reduces the lift — that helps structure, repurpose, connect, and amplify what you already do, in your own voice and your own languages — addresses those constraints without asking you to become a different kind of leader.

This document is a reflected understanding for Liz Rios, intended to be right to the point, true, and valuable. It is preliminary until reviewed and endorsed.

Welcome Letter

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/welcome-letter.md`

Liz

You have built one of the most consequential Latina pastor-scholar-operator bodies of work in North American church planting. Don't Buy The Lie from Ghetto Rose Publications in 2012. Your chapter in Need to Know from 100 Movements Publishing in 2023, alongside Alan Hirsch, Scot McKnight, Jo Saxton, and Lisa Rodriguez-Watson. Rhythms of Rest, co-curated with Ambassador Suzan Johnson Cook at Our Daily Bread. The Oxford University Press chapter "The Women are Warriors," reprinted in the Azusa Street centennial volume. Two dissertations — an EdD from Nova Southeastern, a DMin from Southeastern — and a 2025 MA in Social Justice from Union Theological Seminary. Thirty-five years of pastoring, planting, teaching, and consulting. Founder of Passion2Plant, the only national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network in the United States, and director of Púlpito Fellows, the Lilly Endowment-funded bilingual preaching fellowship at Urban Strategies.

All of it is somewhere. None of it is in one place. Don't Buy The Lie sits on its Amazon author page; the Need to Know contribution lives on 100mpublishing.com and Christianbook; the Oxford chapter sits inside Oxford's catalog and the Azusa centennial reprint. Your columns scatter across Sojourners, Christianity Today, Influence, PCPJ, Red Letter Christians, and Religion News Service — each platform owns its own surface of you. Guest velocity is high and the receipts live on other people's feeds: Be the Bridge with Latasha Morrison, The Mestizo Podcast with Emanuel Padilla, The Protagonistas with Kat Armas, Right Side Up Episode 10 with Danielle Strickland, and The Church Planting Podcast with Greg Nettle and Len Tang. Your own teaching sits inside three uncoordinated owned domains — elizabethrios.com, thepassioncenter.org, passion2plant.com — and your long-form writing splits between the Mujerista in Motion Substack and your Medium archive with no cross-post tissue between them. Two YouTube presences run in parallel: The Passion Center channel and the separate Púlpito Voices channel. The relational layer is fractured the same way. Púlpito Fellows alumni live inside Urban Strategies' staff systems and the Lilly Endowment reporting infrastructure that Aracelis Vasquez Haye coordinates. Sojourners holds you in board records; Freedom Road in Lisa Sharon Harper's consulting CRM; the Latino Leadership Circle's executive team — David Ramos, Luis Alvarez, Orlando Crespo, Belinda Passafaro — in its own internal list; Disciples of Christ in Commission on Ministry rosters; R.E.A.L. THRIVE in mentorship rosters; Outreach Magazine in editorial contact lists since 2008. The thirty-five-year mental rolodex of Latino Pentecostal NYC, ecumenical justice, and 100 Movements lives in your phone and your memory. What is missing is the layer above all of this that lets a reader find their way from the Oxford chapter to the Need to Know essay to the Sojourners column to the Cafecito Conversations episode, and that lets a Latina pastor stay connected to you after she leaves the cohort that introduced her.

The largest pool of value, and the one most at risk of going unwritten, is what lives in your head. The judgment calls behind the Pulpito Fellows curriculum — who to invite into a three-year fellowship, how to sequence a 1.5-day in-person launch with eight Zoom sessions, what counts as one of the three digital products each fellow must produce. The bilingual register choices — which Spanish terms to leave untranslated (Pulpito, Cafecito, Madrinas, Mujerista), which to gloss, when to code-switch inside a single paragraph. The disrupt-and-cultivate calibrations behind every Passion2Plant cohort decision. The preparation behind the 4th Annual Mama Leo Lecture at Union in 2024. The pragmatic wisdom learned in cohort calls, Cafecito tables, classrooms at Fuller, and the Florida College of Preachers induction at Palm Beach Atlantic.

This is where Movemental's AI does work that was not previously possible. The research behind this letter — the inventory just walked through — was compiled by AI sitting with your public corpus for the time a human researcher would have needed weeks to cover. The same approach now turns toward what is not yet public: AI-assisted transcripts of Pulpito Fellows debriefs, course-note extraction from your DMin field work, Cafecito conversation capture, bilingual dictation that becomes draft, draft that becomes essay. The embodied layer can be surfaced at your pace rather than at the pace of a publishing house. The AI does not replace your voice. Every draft is yours to edit, refuse, or rewrite. The tools do the inventorying and the connective tissue. Authorship stays yours.

This is what the dashboard is built to do, and what we will do with you. First, aggregate. Books, articles, dissertations, the Oxford chapter, the Cafecito Conversations and Latinas of Legacy episodes, the Pulpito Fellows session decks, and embodied material as it gets surfaced — pulled into one searchable hub. Second, interconnect. The DMin thesis on justice-oriented churches points at your Sojourners column, which points at the Need to Know chapter, which points at the Pulpito Fellows curriculum, which points back at the DMin. Third, repurpose. The fellowship becomes a public sequenced course; Don't Buy The Lie gets a pathway built around it; the Need to Know chapter gets surfaced alongside the Right Side Up Episode 10 appearance; the Mama Leo Lecture becomes indexed text rather than event memory. Fourth, amplify. Search reach across English and Spanish, network effects with Hirsch, Strickland, and Rodriguez-Watson, the references that arrive once your work is findable in one place. The work this season is not authorship. It is translation of what you have already authored into a form practitioners can actually reach.

A year from now, elizabethrios.com looks different. A mujerista-theology hub gathers Don't Buy The Lie, the Oxford "Women are Warriors" chapter, the Need to Know contribution, the Sojourners and Christianity Today columns, the Mujerista in Motion Substack archive, and the relevant Cafecito episodes under one canonical address. A Pulpito Fellows public archive exists for the first time, cohort by cohort, with each fellow's three digital products surfaced under their name and yours. A newsletter that consolidates Substack and Medium reaches one subscriber list in both languages. A bilingual Latina pastor in Hartford who has never heard of Urban Strategies finds the Mestizo Podcast episode on a Tuesday morning and begins working through the Passion2Plant Just Church track that afternoon.

This is your next season. The work ahead is making the body of work you have already built reach the practitioners it was written for. Your direction of Pulpito Fellows and your founding of Passion2Plant do not contradict this — they are the reason it has to happen now, because the Latina church planters and bilingual preachers your current role serves cannot yet find one searchable home that holds your voice in both languages. Right now they cannot.

— Movemental

Committed Voice

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/_misc/committed-voice.md

slug: liz-rios

display_name: Rev. Dr. Liz Rios

role: Founder, Passion2Plant · Director, Púlpito Fellows · Adjunct, Fuller

location_line: Central Florida & Puerto Rico

short_tagline: >-

Afro-Boricua theologian and live cohort operator who founded and runs the only national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network in the United States.

themes:

- Church Planting
- Mujerista Theology
- Bilingual Formation

credentials:

- "Founder, Passion2Plant — only national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network in the U.S."
- "Director, Púlpito Fellows — Lilly Endowment-funded bilingual preaching fellowship at Urban Strategies"
- "Adjunct Faculty, Fuller Theological Seminary — Church Planting Initiative orbit"
- "Board Member, Sojourners · Senior Consultant, Freedom Road (Lisa Sharon Harper)"
- "Consulting Editor, Outreach Magazine since 2008"
- "Ordained, Christian Church (Disciples of Christ) — Commission on Ministry"

featured_works:

- "Don't Buy The Lie (Ghetto Rose Publications, 2012)"
- "Need to Know — contributor (100 Movements Publishing, 2023)"
- "The Women are Warriors (Oxford University Press)"
- "Mujerista in Motion — Substack"

primary_url: <https://www.elizabethrios.com>

secondary_links:

- label: Passion2Plant

href: <https://www.passion2plant.com>

- label: The Passion Center

href: <https://www.thepassioncenter.org>

signature_frameworks:

- name: Mujerista theology

definition: Theology from the lived experience of Latinas, in the Ada María Isasi-Díaz lineage, that grounds church practice in Afro-Boricua, bilingual, and barrio realities.

- name: The digital pulpit

definition: The Púlpito Fellows thesis that social media and streaming are not adjuncts to

ministry but the primary surface area for this generation of Latina/o leaders.

- name: Holistic, justice-focused churches

definition: Civic engagement and justice praxis are constitutive of healthy church planting, not optional add-ons after the launch service.

- name: Global majority planters

definition: Preferred frame over "minority" or "ethnic" — names BIPOC planters as the demographic core of the future U.S. church rather than a niche.

- name: Prophetic legacy

definition: Self-naming in continuity with Latina foremothers like Mama Leo (Leoncia Rosado Rousseau), claiming ancestry as ecclesial authorization.

- name: Disrupt and cultivate

definition: Passion2Plant's two-beat mission grammar — disrupt oppressive systems, cultivate faith spaces of transformation — held together as one move.

lineage:

sources:

- Ada María Isasi-Díaz
- Leoncia "Mama Leo" Rosado Rousseau
- Bishop Raymond Rivera
- Ambassador Suzan Johnson Cook

peers:

- alan-hirsch
- danielle-strickland
- lisa-rodriguez-watson
- jo-saxton
- scot-mcknight

downstream:

- Pulpito Fellows cohorts (3 cohorts since Spring 2024)
- Passion2Plant Just Church and Trauma cohorts
- R.E.A.L. Black Women in Ministry THRIVE mentees

sources:

- README.md
- summary.md
- profile/biography.md
- profile/identity.md
- profile/voice-analysis.md
- content/content-audit.md
- network/affiliations.md
- network/movemental-overlap.md
- digital-presence.md

research_completed_at: 2026-04-20

generated_at: 2026-05-20

Editorial bio

Liz Rios has carried thirty-five years of ministry across pastoring, planting, teaching, and consulting — and into infrastructure. She founded Passion2Plant in 2020, the only national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network in the United States, and directs Púlpito Fellows, a three-year bilingual preaching fellowship funded by the Lilly Endowment and run in partnership with Urban Strategies.

Her work runs simultaneously across denominational, academic, and movement spaces: ordained in the Christian Church (Disciples of Christ); adjunct faculty at Fuller Theological Seminary; board member at Sojourners; senior consultant with Lisa Sharon Harper's Freedom Road; consulting editor at Outreach Magazine since 2008; executive team member of the Latino Leadership Circle. She holds a BA, MA, EdD from Nova Southeastern, DMin from Southeastern, and a 2025 MA in Social Justice from Union Theological Seminary.

She writes from a *mujerista* frame — distinct in tone and theological surface area from anyone else inside Movemental's circle — and contributes to 100 Movements Publishing's *Need to Know* alongside Alan Hirsch, Scot McKnight, and Jo Saxton. In October 2025 she became the only woman inducted into Palm Beach Atlantic University's inaugural Florida College of Preachers, and brings a live cohort operator's discipline to what a leader-platform actually has to carry.

Sources

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/sources.md

Sources — Liz Rios research

All primary URLs consulted during the 2026-04-20 research pass. Re-verify before citing in public-facing copy.

Her own sites

- elizabethrios.com
- elizabethrios.com/about
- elizabethrios.com/books
- elizabethrios.com/media
- elizabethrios.com/what-others-say-about-dr-liz
- elizabethrios.com/latinas-of-legacy

Organizations she founded / directs

- passion2plant.com/who-we-are
- thepassioncenter.org/users/rev-dr-elizabeth-rios
- thepassioncenter.org/users/dr-elizabeth-rios
- urbanstrategies.us/programs/pulpito-fellows-program
- thepassioncenter.org/news/tpc-founder-inaugurated-into-palm-beach-atlantics-florida-college-of-preachers

Boards & partners

- freedomroad.us/who-we-are/rev-dr-liz-rios
- pcpj.org/author/revdrlizrios
- latinoleadershipcircle.org
- sojo.net/biography/elizabeth-d-rios

Academic

- independentresearcher.academia.edu/ElizabethRios
- seuniversity.academia.edu/ElizabethRios

Book / publisher pages

- [Amazon author page](#)
- 100mpublishing.com/product/need-to-know
- [Need to Know on Amazon](#)

Interviews & coverage

- [Bold Journey — Meet Rev. Dr. Elizabeth Rios](#)
- [Union Theological Seminary — 4th Annual Mama Leo Lecture Series](#)
- [Ep. 117 Micro & Multiethnic Churches & the Future of Church Planting](#)
- [Fuller Church Planting Initiative](#)

Professional networks

- [LinkedIn — drlizrios](#)
- [RocketReach profile](#)

Research status

- Snapshot date: 2026-04-20
- All sources WebFetch'd or WebSearch'd; no primary interview yet
- Verify volatile status items (Union MA 2025 graduation date, Palm Beach Atlantic induction date, Púlpito cohort recruiting status) before public use

Misc · Digital-Presence-Source

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/_misc/digital-presence-source.md

Digital presence — Rev. Dr. Liz Rios

Owned domains

Domain	Purpose	Notes
elizabethrios.com	Personal brand site	Bio, books, media, testimonials, Latinas of Legacy. Primary author platform.
thepassioncenter.org	Training center + community	Organizational home for her teaching.
passion2plant.com	Church planting network	Cohort applications, values, partner list.

Newsletter / long-form writing

- **Substack** — Mujerista in Motion (handle: [drlizrios](https://drlizrios.substack.com))
- **Medium** — drlizrios.medium.com

Both are active, she writes under both flags. Confirm subscriber counts via direct contact; not public.

Social handles (confirmed)

- Facebook — [@thepassioncenter](https://www.facebook.com/thepassioncenter) and personal
- Instagram — [@thepassioncenter](https://www.instagram.com/thepassioncenter)
- YouTube — [@thepassioncenter](https://www.youtube.com/channel/UC...) (The Passion Center channel)
- YouTube — **Púlpito Voices** (separate channel for Púlpito Fellows program)
- LinkedIn — [drlizrios](https://www.linkedin.com/company/dr-liz-rios) — listed title: "Urban Strategies"
- X/Twitter — presence likely but not prominent in search results (verify)

Podcast platforms

- Hosts / moderates: **Latino Leadership Circle Podcast** (Apple Podcasts)
- Featured series on her own channels: Cafecito Conversations, Latinas of Legacy, Passion2Plant Mentor Moment

Email / contact

- drlizrios@gmail.com (public personal)

- erios@urbanstrategies.us (Púlpito Fellows program)
- Mail: P.O. Box 580527, Kissimmee, FL 34758

Academic profiles

- Academia.edu: independentresearcher.academia.edu/ElizabethRios and seuniversity.academia.edu/ElizabethRios

Amazon author page

- amazon.com/stores/author/B00B1R43M2

Platform health assessment (subjective)

Surface	Assessment	Gap / opportunity
Personal site	Comprehensive but static — reads like a portfolio, not a content engine	Could benefit from a full pillar-page architecture and corpus-backed RAG
Substack + Medium	Actively publishing but split brand across two platforms	Consolidation or cross-post automation
YouTube (two channels)	Active but low-production; content captured at events	Editorial cadence + Púlpito Fellows archive could anchor a searchable library
Podcast footprint	Very high guest velocity — she is a repeat guest in multiple networks	Own hosted feed for her work is under-developed
Search footprint	Strong under "Liz Rios" + "Elizabeth Rios" pastor variants; some name-collision risk with academics of similar name	Canonical identity anchor (Wikipedia-style or schema.org Person) would help

Movemental-fit signals from the digital footprint

- She already **treats the web as pulpit** (Púlpito Fellows thesis). The platform's Content System Build is an exact fit for her own stated program deliverables ("three digital products per fellow").
- She has the **authored corpus volume** (articles, dissertations, chapters, podcasts) to make RAG + voice-agent work materially useful — she is past the cold-start problem.
- Her audience **does not currently have a first-class author platform** representing Latina Pentecostal / mujerista voice at Hirsch-tier production quality. Movemental can be that platform for her.

Misc · Network · Affiliations

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/_misc/network/affiliations.md

Affiliations — Rev. Dr. Liz Rios

Organizations she has **founded, led, taught at, sat on a board of, or consulted for**, with approximate time windows.

Organizations founded

Org	Role	Est.	Still active	Notes
Passion2Plant	Founder	2020	Yes	Only national BIPOC-woman-led church planting network in the U.S. Three cohorts: Just Church, Trauma, Pulpito Fellows.
The Passion Center	Founder & Community Curator	~2020	Yes	Missional online faith community + training center. Umbrella brand for her teaching/media work.
Center for Emerging Female Leadership (NYC)	Founder	1996	Closed 2001	Earliest flagship; mentored emerging women leaders in NYC.
Urban Ministry Conferences (at Nyack College)	Founder / Convener	mid-2000s	Unclear	Drew hundreds of urban missiologists and practitioners.

Programs she currently directs

Program	Parent org	Funder	Start	Structure
Pulpito Fellows	Urban Strategies (in partnership w/ Passion2Plant)	Lilly Endowment	Spring 2024	3-year preaching fellowship, 10-week cohorts, bilingual, 1.5-day in-person launch + 8 Zoom sessions. Each fellow creates 3 digital products. Coordinator: Rev. Aracelis Vasquez Haye.

Current board / leadership roles

Org	Role	Domain
Sojourners	Board Member	Ecumenical Christian media & justice advocacy
Latino Leadership Circle	Executive Team + Podcast Moderator	Latino Christian leaders collective. Founder/President: Rev. David Ramos. Other execs: Rev. Dr. Luis Alvarez, Rev. Dr. Orlando Crespo, Elder Belinda Passafaro.
Christian Church (Disciples of Christ)	Commission on Ministry member	Denominational governance
Freedom Road (Lisa Sharon Harper)	Senior Consultant & Special Projects	Racial justice consultancy
Urban Strategies	Co-vocational leader (20+ years)	Community development / ministry formation
R.E.A.L. Black Women in Ministry THRIVE initiative	Senior Mentor (4+ years)	BIPOC women in ministry formation
Fuller Theological Seminary	Adjunct Faculty	Church planting / missiology (CPI orbit)
Outreach Magazine	Consulting Editor	Since 2008

Prior / former board + leadership

Org	Role	Notes
National Latino Evangelical Coalition (NaLEC)	Board member	Panelist at 2018 Summit with Ed Stetzer
Evangelicals for Social Action	Advisory board	
Nyack College	Asst. Professor of Christian Education + Exec. Director of Advancement	mid-2000s
Primitive Christian Church (PCC), NYC	Credentialed by Assemblies of God	Early ministry credentialing
Latino Pastoral Action Center (LPAC)	Mentored by Bishop Raymond Rivera	Early formation

Partner organizations (via Passion2Plant)

- **CBE International** — Women and The Church course partnership
- **Faith-based Latino Mental Health Hub**
- **Christianity Today** — Black & Evangelical partnership
- **P2P Seminary Now** — in-house learning platform

Denominational / ecumenical memberships

- Christian Church (Disciples of Christ) — ordination home
- Pentecostals and Charismatics for Peace and Justice (PCPJ) — contributing author
- MLK Jr. College of Ministers and Laity Board of Preachers (2023 induction)
- Florida College of Preachers, Palm Beach Atlantic University — inaugural inductee (Oct 2025, only woman)

Sorority / civic

- Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc. — 39-year member; charter member, South Broward Alumnae Chapter

Misc · Network · Endorsers

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/_misc/network/endorsers.md

Endorsers & direct network — Rev. Dr. Liz Rios

Named endorsers pulled from elizabethrios.com/what-others-say plus co-speakers / co-contributors identified across corpus. Treat as **direct-first-degree contacts**.

Named endorsers (from own site)

Name	Title / Org	Relationship signal
Dr. Suzan Johnson Cook	Former U.S. Ambassador of Religious Freedom; Pastor	Strong — co-curator on Rhythms of Rest; presented Unsung Sheroe Award (2023)
Brian McLaren	Author, former pastor	Progressive evangelical bridge
Kristyn Komarnicki	Former Editor, PRISM Magazine / Christians for Social Action	Publishing relationship
Rev. Dr. Marc Rivera	Senior Pastor, Iglesia Cristiana Primitiva (PCC), NYC	Denominational home / early credentialing lineage
Fernando Arzola Jr., PhD	Former Associate Dean, Nyack College	Academic/colleague from Nyack era
Lisa Sharon Harper	Founder, Freedom Road LLC; Speaker/Writer/Activist	Strong — she is Senior Consultant at Freedom Road
Rev. Dr. Michael Carrion	Founding Pastor & Sr. Director, Promised Land Covenant Church / Redeemer City to City	Urban ministry / NYC network
Dr. Dale Dan	President, The Joy-at-Work Center (JAWC)	—
Dr. Robert Chao Romero	UCLA Professor; Author of Brown Church	Latino theology/scholarship overlap
Rich Robinson	Movement Catalyst, Leadership Coach, Spiritual Entrepreneur	Likely Forge / 100 Movements network
Daniel Yang	Director, Churches of Welcome, World Relief	Co-author on Inalienable (Yang/Ortland/Rah); co-panelist Fuller
Bishop Raymond Rivera	Founder, Latino Pastoral Action Center / Family Life Academy Charter Schools / CHCCM	Foundational mentor — her formational figure

100 Movements Publishing / Need to Know co-contributors (first-degree via Hirsch imprint)

Name	Movemental leader folder
Alan Hirsch	alan-hirsch/
Scot McKnight	scot-mcknight/
Jo Saxton	jo-saxton/
Lisa Rodriguez-Watson	lisa-rodriguez-watson/
Beth Allison Barr	beth-allison-barr/
Mandy Smith	mandy-smith/
Danielle Strickland (curator)	danielle-strickland/
Bob Ekblad	not in repo (potential add)
Lori Anne Thompson	lori-anne-thompson/

Co-speakers / co-panelists (partial)

Name	Context
Ed Stetzer	NaLEC Latino Summit 2018 panel
Len Tang	Fuller CPI episodes (2024, 2025); Church Planting Podcast
Greg Nettle	Church Planting Podcast
Daniel Yang	Fuller Missiology Lectures 2023; video interview
Dr. Soong-Chan Rah	Fuller Missiology Lectures 2023
Latasha Morrison	Be the Bridge podcast — Leaders of Color: Latinx
Kat Armas	The Protagonistas — Theology in El Barrio
Emanuel Padilla	The Mestizo Podcast — Loving DJ
José Humphreys	JustUs Talks — Seeing Jesus in East Harlem
Dr. Eli Valentín	COGIC Hispanic Initiatives Podcast
Dr. Susan Maros	Calling in Context interview
Dr. Susan Harris Howell	Buried Talents interview
Sheila Wray Gregoire	Christians Under the Covers
Daisy Machado	HSP Exchange Feminista Chats
Dieula Previlon	Elevate Life — grief/loss conversation

Latino Leadership Circle executive team (close peers)

- Rev. David Ramos (founder/president)
- Rev. Dr. Luis Alvarez
- Rev. Dr. Orlando Crespo
- Elder Belinda Passafaro

Family / kin

- **Rev. Hiram Rios** — husband, co-ministry partner, 35+ years married

Network heatmap

- **Densest cluster:** Latino Pentecostal / Disciples of Christ NYC lineage (Rivera, Carrion, Arzola, PCC, LPAC, NaLEC)
- **Second densest:** Justice-oriented ecumenical cluster (Sojourners, Freedom Road, Red Letter Christians, PCPJ, Evangelicals for Social Action)
- **Third densest (and highest relevance for movemental):** 100 Movements Publishing / Forge-adjacent cluster — Hirsch, Strickland, Saxton, Rodriguez-Watson, Smith
- **Academic:** Fuller (Len Tang, Soong-Chan Rah), Union Theological Seminary (Daisy Machado, Mama Leo legacy), Nyack (Arzola), Southeastern, Nova Southeastern

Misc · Network · Movemental-Overlap

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/liz-rios/_misc/network/movemental-overlap.md

Movemental-network overlap — Rev. Dr. Liz Rios

Mapping Liz Rios' direct ties to leaders who already have a research folder under docs/movement_leader_research/.

First-degree (co-authored, co-taught, or directly cited)

Movemental leader	Tie	Strength
Alan Hirsch	Co-contributor, Need to Know (100 Movements Publishing, 2023)	Medium — shared page between same covers; confirm whether they have corresponded directly
Danielle Strickland	Need to Know curator; Strickland hosted Rios on Right Side Up podcast (Ep. 10 w/ Lisa Rodriguez-Watson)	Strong — direct repeat collaboration
Lisa Rodriguez-Watson	Co-contributor Need to Know; co-guest on Right Side Up Ep. 10	Strong — shared platform and audience
Jo Saxton	Co-contributor Need to Know	Medium
Beth Allison Barr	Co-contributor Need to Know	Medium
Mandy Smith	Co-contributor Need to Know	Medium
Scot McKnight	Co-contributor Need to Know	Medium
Lori Anne Thompson	Co-contributor Need to Know	Medium
Ed Stetzer	Co-panelist, NaLEC Latino Summit 2018	Light
Brad Brisco	No direct tie in public record, but both sit in Exponential / Send Institute / CPLF orbit — Brad is Send Institute-linked and Rios has written for Send Institute ("COVID-19's Burden on the Black and Brown Church")	Light — worth a warm intro

Second-degree (shared institutions, not confirmed direct)

Shared node	Who else movemental cares about
Fuller Church Planting Initiative	Len Tang (director), Daniel Yang — adjacent to jr-woodward , mandy-smith , neil-cole orbit
Sojourners	Lisa Sharon Harper history; justice-cluster authors
Outreach Magazine	Cover coverage and editorial role — reaches Brad Brisco / Ed Stetzer's audience
City to City (Redeemer)	Michael Carrion endorses her; Multi-cultural Excellence Award from City to City Miami
100 Movements Publishing / Forge	Alan's publishing imprint; she is inside the house

Reverse mapping — who should meet her first

If movemental does warm intros, sequence:

1. **Alan Hirsch** (co-author on record) — simplest intro path.
2. **Danielle Strickland** (already platformed her) — strongest relational trust.
3. **Lisa Rodriguez-Watson** (co-guest, co-contributor) — natural bridge; LRW is already in the movemental research pipeline and may already be talking to her.
4. **Scot McKnight / Jo Saxton** — existing movemental-adjacent endorsers who can write on her behalf to 100M readers.

Distinctive value she brings that no existing leader brings

- Latina / Afro-Boricua / mujerista theological tradition (none of alan-hirsch , brad-brisco , jo-saxton , scot-mcknight , beth-allison-barr , mandy-smith , danielle-strickland , lisa-rodriguez-watson occupy this tradition primarily)
- BIPOC women-led church planting operator with active, funded cohorts (most movemental leaders are content producers; she runs a live training pipeline)
- Bilingual platform and audience (Spanish-English) — expands addressable market
- Direct connections to Union, Fuller, MLK Jr. College of Ministers, Palm Beach Atlantic — diverse institutional footprint